AOU
الجامعة العربية المفتوحة
Arab Open University

Name .....
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Faculty of Business Studies

BUC111: Business Communication 1

Final Examination / Version: A

2024 – 2025 Spring
3-Jun-2025

Number of Exam Pages: 6 (including this cover sheet)	Time Allowed: 2 hours

Instructions:

1- Take **FIVE (5)** minutes to read all instructions carefully before attempting to write.
2- Mobile phones must be in "SWITCHED **OFF**" mode throughout the examination.
3- This is a **CLOSED** book examination. NO documents of any kind are allowed.
4- You **MUST** answer the questions using only the answer booklets provided
5- You **MUST** return the examination paper together with your answer booklets.
6- Do **NOT** write your answers in pencil except graphs/sketches
7- Students are **NOT** allowed to use any type of dictionary or mobile phones during the ex
8- Students are allowed to use ***non-programmable*** calculators only (if needed).
9- Any form of cheating will **NOT** be tolerated and will subject you to AOU Cheating Poli

Part	No. of questions	Time	Marks	Earned Marks	Signat
Part I	12	25 minutes	24		
Part II	6	15 minutes	18		
Part III	1	20 minutes	12		
Part IV	4	30 minutes	20		
Part V	1	30 minutes	26		
Total	24	120 minutes	100		

Part I: Multiple-Choice Section: Choose the most appropriate answer. (24 marks)

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1. Which of the following is the first step in writing a business message?
   a) Selecting the appropriate medium
   b) Organizing the information
   c) Analyzing the situation and audience
   d) Composing the draft

2. In business communication, what should you prioritize when revising your message?
   a) Accuracy and clarity
   b) Creativity
   c) Length of the message
   d) Use of humor

3. The use of "you-attitude" in business messages refers to:
   a) Focusing on the sender's needs
   b) Focusing on the receiver's needs
   c) Using professional language
   d) Writing formal language

4. What is the purpose of proofreading a business message?
   a) To revise the message for clarity
   b) To ensure correctness in grammar and spelling
   c) To confirm the correct use of a channel
   d) To increase the length of the message

5. Which of the following is an example of using a direct approach in a business message?
   a) Telling the recipient the news right away
   b) Giving the recipient time to understand the news
   c) Avoiding clear and concise wording
   d) Offering an apology before giving the information

6. When creating a business message, why is it important to maintain a professional tone?
   a) To appear approachable
   b) To establish credibility
   c) To be entertaining
   d) To avoid misunderstandings

7. What is the primary goal of a routine business message?
   a) To address complex issues
   b) To share good news or updates
   c) To persuade the recipient
   d) To ask for sensitive or private information

8. In a positive message, the main idea should:
   a) Be placed at the end of the message
   b) Be placed at the beginning of the message
   c) Be discussed only in the middle of the message
   d) Be stated in a way that causes confusion

9. Which of the following is a key strategy for delivering negative news in a message?
   a) Provide the bad news upfront
   b) Use positive or neutral language to cushion the news
   c) Make the negative message as brief as possible

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d) Avoid offering any alternatives or solutions

10. In writing a negative message, the indirect approach helps to:
    a) Immediately upset the reader
    b) Provide a clear explanation for the decision
    c) Create confusion in the reader's mind
    d) Make the negative message appear positive

11. Which of the following would be considered an ethical approach to persuasive writing?
    a) Using exaggerations to persuade the audience
    b) Making misleading claims to achieve the desired outcome
    c) Providing accurate, clear, and truthful information to back up the argument
    d) Ignoring any negative aspects of the product or service being promoted

12. Which of the following is the most important consideration when tailoring a persuasive message to a specific audience?
    a) Making the message longer to provide more details
    b) Understanding the audience's needs, concerns, and values
    c) Focusing solely on the writer's point of view
    d) Using complex language to demonstrate expertise

Part II: Fill in the blanks: Use appropriate words from the box to fill in the blanks. **(18 marks)**

positive – negative – tailor – proofreading – tone – editing – influence

1. _____ helps to ensure that the message is clear, correct, and free from unnecessary repetition or ambiguity.

2. _____ is the process of checking the final draft for errors in grammar, spelling, punctuation, and formatting.

3. _____ should remain formal or semi-formal, depending on the audience, to convey professionalism and respect for the recipient.

4. It is important to _____ the level of formality in your message to fit the audience and the situation.

5. In a _____ message, it's important to show appreciation, expressing gratitude to reinforce a positive relationship with the recipient.

6. The goal of a persuasive message is to _____ the recipient's attitudes, beliefs, or behaviors in favor of your ideas or actions.

Part III: What are the four aspects of being sensitive to audience needs when writing business messages? **(12 marks)**

1. ----------
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2. ----------

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3. ---
4. ---

Part IV - Evaluating Business Messages: Read the case and the email below, then answer the questions that follow. (20 marks)

Tim Johns, who works at Beacon Enterprises, has requested time off for personal reasons. He has submitted a formal request for time off via email to the HR manager, Adam Chin, hoping to take a few days off in the coming weeks.

However, due to the team's current workload, tight deadlines, and a crucial upcoming project, the manager has decided that they cannot approve the time off request. The team is already short-staffed, and the manager fears that granting the request could further disrupt the workflow and delay critical deliverables. The email, however, does not follow the criteria for writing effective negative messages

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Subject: Denied Request for Time Off

Dear Tim,

I'm writing to let you know that your request for time off has been denied. We are too busy right now, and we cannot afford to have you absent. Given that last time we allowed someone to take time off, it caused major delays, it's clear that time off just disrupts our workflow. Please understand that this decision is final, and we need you to stay focused on your tasks.

Regards,
Adam

Questions:

1. What elements make the email ineffective? Justify your answer by giving 3 examples from the email

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2. Is the direct approach the best approach in this case? Why or why not?

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3. What further information should the email include? Why?

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4. Identify the logical fallacy in the email. (Name it and write the example from the email.)

Part V - Crafting Business Messages: You are Adam Chin, the HR manager at Beacon Enterprises. **REWRITE** the email to Tim Johns in an **appropriate** way, making the necessary **changes** and following the **criteria** of writing effective negative messages. **(26 marks.)**

To:
Subject:

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